



Checklist for the Wedding or Anniversary

Since every wedding (also any anniversary) is designed individually, there is no generally applicable wedding or anniversary schedule. However, following a few guidelines can avoid stress. Therefore, please understand the following wedding checklist (and the anniversary checklist you have adapted yourself) only as a rough guide for wedding planning or anniversary planning.

You can also print out and customize the wedding checklist / anniversary checklist and check off the individual points or enter your individual details.

Checklist - 6 to 12 months before the wedding

☐ Determine the type of wedding

- * Civil marriage?
- * Church wedding?
- * Marriage with a freelance theologian?
- * Round (major) birthday, wedding anniversary (silver/golden wedding), other occasion

☐ Determine the framework of the wedding (anniversary analogous)

- * Estimate the size of the wedding reception (number of wedding guests)
- * Traditional or unusual? Clothing style?
- * Restaurant or party service?
- * Outdoor or indoor?
- * Should there be a bachelor/ette party?

☐ **Determine the wedding date (anniversary analogous)**

The wedding date should be set as soon as possible, otherwise the desired date may be taken (at the registry office or with the priest, or with the independent theologian) and you will have to look for a new date for the wedding.

In addition, the wedding date should be discussed with the closest family and the (probable) witnesses.

Civil marriage on at o'clock

Church / independent wedding on at o'clock

☐ **Choose a restaurant / wedding location, book a wedding date (anniversary analogous)**

Beautiful and popular locations for weddings or anniversaries are usually booked up early. Therefore, after determining the wedding or anniversary date, you should also immediately arrange the date for the wedding / anniversary with the desired location.

Restaurant / Location:

☐ **Book a honeymoon or anniversary holiday**

Your honeymoon must also be booked early, as it usually starts the day after your wedding. Also think about any necessary vaccinations and your passport (and visa) and remember to apply for vacation.

☐ **Submit a wedding leave application**

After you have planned your honeymoon, you should also apply for honeymoon leave from your employer in good time.

☐ **Create a wedding cost plan (anniversary analogous)**

Create a (provisional) cost plan for your wedding or anniversary now, in which you enter the planned costs and add them up. During the wedding/anniversary preparations, you should continually update this plan, especially when you know the actual costs.

We have compiled a further overview of the costs you need to think about for your wedding or anniversary, called the Wedding/Anniversary Cost Planner.

☐ **Create wedding folder (anniversary analogous)**

Create a wedding or anniversary folder now in which you can collect all the documents relating to your wedding or anniversary.

Checklist - 4 to 6 months before the wedding

☐ Compile a preliminary wedding guest list (anniversary analogous)

You will also need this list when creating the wedding or anniversary invitation cards and when managing the feedback from your wedding or anniversary guests. It is best to create the wedding or anniversary guest list in electronic form so that you can easily edit it in the next few weeks.

☐ Appointing witnesses

Nowadays, witnesses are only required for Catholic weddings. If you would like to have witnesses for your wedding (including at the registry office or at a wedding officiated a freelance theologian), you can decide for yourself whether you want one witness or two.

☐ Discuss the wedding with the priest or independent theologian

If the wedding is desired with a priest or independent theologian, then further preparations are necessary:

- * Discuss the wedding ceremony
- * Choosing lyrics and songs for the wedding ceremony
- * Designing a songbook
- * Organize music

☐ Organizing music for the wedding reception (anniversary analogous)

Book a DJ, a musician or a wedding band for your wedding reception early and discuss the music you want.

☐ Organize a wedding photographer (anniversary analogous)

Choose the wedding photographer and/or wedding videographer who will capture your wedding in pictures and film (and sound) and discuss the general sequence of the recordings and your special wishes for and during the wedding and/or wedding ceremony.

☐ Rent a wedding car (anniversary analogous)

For the journey from home to the registry office and/or from the registry office to the church or wedding location, you may want an exceptional vehicle for an exceptional day. It's best to book your dream car for your wedding now.

☐ **Planning a party service (anniversary analogous)**

If you are not celebrating in a restaurant, you should get offers for party services, tent rentals, etc. You may also need additional help for serving food and drinks (sometimes the party service also offers this).

☐ **Determine wedding contact persons for the wedding guests (anniversary analogous)**

Explain to the wedding contact person your ideas about how the wedding celebration should go and in particular what unpleasant surprises you don't want. Your wedding guests can then contact the wedding contact person about surprises, wedding games or your wedding table.

☐ **Book additional entertainment (anniversary analogous)**

If you are planning other entertainment in addition to music (e.g. magicians, fire works, balloon starts, etc.), you should start getting offers now. Please note: a wedding guest may want to surprise you with a similar action, so be sure to discuss this with the wedding contact person for your wedding guests.

☐ **Create a wedding table or wedding list (anniversary analogous)**

You can state where you have set up your wedding gift table already on the invitation, otherwise each wedding guest will ask individually about your wedding wishes.

A large piggy bank is a good option for cash gifts.
A wedding list or piggy bank is also possible online.

☐ **Find a printing company - Order wedding invitation cards (anniversary analogous)**

Your wedding invitation cards (and table and menu cards) must be printed in good time. For larger weddings (over 100 wedding guests), you should get various quotes. You can also order wedding invitation cards online (in this case, you should definitely consider ordering different sample copies separately).

A note about the wedding table and information about accommodation options (hotels, guest houses) for your wedding guests can already be printed on the wedding invitation card.

☐ **Book a wedding dance course (anniversary analogous)**

If you and your wedding guests are planning to dance at the wedding, the bride and the groom traditionally start the dance evening - you may want to brush up on your dance steps for the wedding dance.

Checklist - 3 to 4 months before the wedding

☐ Choosing a wedding dress

The wedding dress must be chosen in good time, as wedding dresses are usually one size fits all (i.e. they are not available in multiple sizes) and must either be ordered or adjusted by a seamstress. Often several fittings and adjustments are necessary. Please note that your figure may change before the wedding and you may not want to have the dress finally adjusted to your figure until four weeks before the wedding.

☐ Choosing clothes for the groom

Here, too, alterations may still be necessary and final adjustments should only be made four weeks before the wedding so that the suit does not become too tight.

☐ Choosing wedding rings

As with wedding dresses, wedding rings often only come in one size, so the correct size is measured and then the wedding rings are ordered. Any engraving must also be ordered. Depending on the type of wedding ring, the ring adjustment can take between two and four weeks.

☐ Compile the final wedding guest list, send out wedding invitations

Now is the time to send out the official wedding invitations. The most important people have known about the wedding date for a long time and have certainly kept it free.

☐ Compile papers for the registry office and church

Collect all the necessary papers and file them in the wedding folder. Please note that the necessary papers may vary from country to country. As an example, only documents for the Federal Republic of Germany are listed here:

*** Personal registration at the registry office**

Registration can only be done in person (it's best to make an appointment at the registry office beforehand so that you don't find yourself standing in front of closed doors). Registration for marriage takes place directly at the registry office of the place of residence of one of the two fiancés. Even if you want to have an outdoor wedding or get married somewhere else entirely, the local registry office is always the first point of contact. Please note: fees apply.

If both partners cannot be present at the appointment to register the marriage, you will definitely need a signed power of attorney from your partner. Check the registry office website to see if there is a form for this.

Before the registry office appointment to register, think about your questions and write them down.

* **Public announcement of marriage**

Since 1998, a public announcement of marriage at the registry office has no longer been necessary in Germany. This means that the obligation to display a notice has also been abolished. In addition, it is no longer compulsory to have witnesses, but one or two witnesses can be officially registered if desired. They should be of legal age and able to present a valid ID card.

* **Documents for the registry office: what do you need to get married?**

For German citizens from birth who are of legal age and were not born abroad, the documents required for registering a marriage at the registry office are manageable.

But be careful: in all other cases, you should first ask your local registry office for the necessary documents by letter, email or telephone. In these cases, it is usually more complicated as to which documents you need to bring with you.

Tipp: International couples, foreigners or those who decide on short notice sometimes find the bureaucratic hurdles in Germany too great - then a marriage in Denmark (recognized worldwide) can be the solution.

The following documents are required for German citizens:

- Passport or identity card (ID)
- Certified copy of the birth register (not older than 6 months)
- Extended registration certificate, which contains your marital status, nationality, religious affiliation and place of residence (if you are not registered in the city of question).
- Certificate of singleness
- Certificate of capacity to marry (certificate from the German registry office for marriage abroad)

The documents for the marriage must be submitted by both fiancés.

You can get the extended registration certificate from the residents' registration office of your place of residence/municipality, and the certified copy of the birth register is issued to you by the registry office of your place of birth. You can often also request these documents online from the relevant offices.

Warning: beware of rip-offs from external online providers - check carefully to make sure you are really on the official website of the city/municipality.

Please note: it may take a few weeks for the transcript to reach you. So please allow enough time!

Further wedding documents are required if

1. one of them was married before

If you have already been married, the registry office will also require a current copy of the marriage register of your last marriage with the dissolution note of divorce/death (not older than 6 months). You can get this from the registry office where your last marriage was concluded.

2. one or both of you are widowed

Widowed people must prove the death of their deceased partner when they remarry. The death certificate is usually presented for this purpose. This can be requested from the registry office that registered the death. If the death occurred abroad, a translation of the death certificate is required. In order to be recognized, the certificate must be prepared and certified by sworn translators. The certificate from the resident's register must also be presented in the case of a widowed person.

3. they have children together

In this case, the registry office will ask you for the birth certificate in which both parents are listed or certified copies of the acknowledgment of paternity.

If there are children from previous relationships, it is important to clearly explain the family situation. This often requires proof of sole or joint custody. This proof can be provided by a court order or a custody agreement.

4. one of you does not have German citizenship

General statements are often made about which documents foreigners need for a wedding in Germany. However, the legal regulations are so different that a general statement is not useful. **Be sure to find out beforehand from your registry office which documents must be presented.** Depending on the country in which the documents were issued, they must be confirmed by an apostille or legalization and translated into German by a translator who is publicly sworn or recognized in Germany. If necessary, an international certificate can also be issued, which is then immediately valid.

5. one of you was born or adopted abroad

You should also ask the registry office directly what other documents are required. The requirements mentioned above also apply here.

In all special cases , it is best to ask your registry office specifically which documents you need - this can vary depending on the case and registry office!

Choose a **family register** that suits you well in time, which you can get in advance or you can buy one from the registry office on site.

If you are only planning a civil wedding and are not going for a church or civil ceremony, light your **wedding candle** in the registry office. This romantic ritual is by no means limited to the church. There are also so many beautiful examples that will enchant you and your wedding day and later on and will provide you with beautiful memories.

It is now possible to play **music** in the wedding room in many registry offices. Discuss this with the registrar and then put together a small playlist if necessary. The entrance, ceremony and end can also be celebrated with music at a civil wedding.

If the civil wedding is your only wedding, then you can (after consulting the registry office) make it **really festive**, with ring exchange, musician, sand ceremony, etc. - in the first conversation with the registrar you should definitely clarify whether this is possible and if necessary visit another registry office.

*** Church wedding**

In Germany, a church wedding can only take place after a legally valid marriage at the registry office. Different documents are required depending on the confession.

- Catholic wedding

Civil marriage certificate / registration for marriage at the registry office

Current baptism certificate / baptism certificate

Valid identification document

Proof that both partners are single

Proof of attendance at a marriage preparation seminar

Marriage license (if the wedding takes place in another municipality)

- Protestant wedding

Civil marriage certificate / registration for marriage at the registry office

Current baptism certificate / baptism certificate

Valid identification document

Dimissoriale (for marriage in another parish)

☐ **Choosing wedding flower decorations**

You can now choose the florist and order the wedding floral decorations for the celebration or the wedding car. The bride can then give instructions on what she wants the bouquet to look like - however ordering the flowers is traditionally the groom's job.

Checklist - 1 to 2 months before the wedding

☐ **Add replies to the wedding guest list**

You should now have received responses from your wedding guests. Update the wedding guest list and follow up if there are no responses. Cancellations from your wedding guests may already contain wedding gifts. Therefore, create the "who gave what" list now so that you can also send wedding thank you cards to these people after the honeymoon.

☐ **Print Wedding song sheet / wedding program booklet**

If you are having a church wedding, you should have the wedding song sheet or wedding program booklet printed now.

☐ **Order wedding cake**

Order your wedding cake now from the confectioner of your choice.

☐ **Trial wedding hairstyle**

The bride in particular should have her desired wedding hairstyle and make-up done at least once so that there are no surprises (and disappointments) on the wedding day.

☐ **Set hair and beauty appointment and time for the wedding**

☐ **Organize a bachelor/ette party**

The stag night can be a big party. Here too, the stag night location, food and drinks and other "surprises" have to be organized.

Checklist - 2 to 4 months before the wedding

☐ **Organizing accommodation for wedding guests**

Discuss accommodation with the out-of-town wedding guests. Family members are often willing to accommodate one or more wedding guests in their own house.

☐ **Pick up wedding rings for the wedding**

The wedding rings for the wedding should be here by now. If not, you need to follow up urgently.

☐ **Create a wedding organization plan**

Create the exact schedule for your wedding and discuss it with the wedding helpers. It is best if you appoint a wedding contact for your wedding helpers who can also make decisions for you during the celebration. Then you can enjoy your wedding day without constant "disturbances" from the wedding helpers.

☐ **Determine the wedding menu and the course of the wedding ceremony**

Now clarify the schedule and the wedding menu for the wedding reception with the restaurant. In this context, the seating/table arrangement (who sits where!) should also be clarified and the arrangement of the tables should be determined. You should also determine the schedule of the wedding reception, with activities and times, if you are using the whole day with it.

☐ **Arrange wedding guest transport (bus, taxi, transfer by other guests)**

The wedding guests also need to be transported between the registry office, restaurant or church (you should have already organized your wedding car!). Are there parking problems? Is there a construction site on the way? Should a bus be hired for transport so that no one has to miss out on a drink or two?

☐ **Try on wedding clothes**

The wedding dress and suit should be put on again. Perhaps final adjustments still need to be made. Does the bride have spare stockings or tights?

☐ **Bridal bouquet and boutonniere**

Traditionally, the bridal bouquet and boutonniere are the groom's job. If he hasn't already done so, he should choose the florist and order the bridal bouquet and boutonniere for the wedding day. Both should match the wedding floral decorations (wedding reception, wedding car).

Checklist - 1 to 2 months before the wedding

☐ **Preparing for the honeymoon**

Shortly before the wedding, you won't have time for this. So think about sunscreen, insect repellent, a first aid kit, travel insurance (travel cancellation insurance, travel health insurance, etc.), credit cards, traveler's checks, foreign currency(ies) in cash, etc.

☐ **Breaking in wedding shoes**

New shoes are usually uncomfortable. But you will be walking in your new wedding shoes the whole wedding day, so it is better to break them in now.

☐ **Finalize the wedding date with the service providers and important people**

For your own peace of mind and in case of inability to attend/illness: coordinate the date(s) with the registry office and those involved there, the priest, the independent theologian, musician/DJ, driver for the wedding car, confectioner, florist, photographer, videographer, etc. Does everyone know where the locations (registry office, church, restaurant) are, how to get there and when they have to be there at the latest? Better safe than sorry!

Checklist - the last day before the wedding

☐ **Packing suitcases for the honeymoon**

☐ **Prepare cash**

You need cash for the collection at the church wedding, for the flower and gift delivery people, possibly the musician, the band, the DJ, tips for the chauffeur, the restaurant staff or the party service!

☐ **Packing the bride's handbag**

Make-up, sewing kit, spare tights, headache tablets, deodorant, comb, plasters, etc. should be nearby (or: appoint a wedding contact or family member who has everything with them).

The following is also useful: hand mirror, nail file, hairpins, chewing gum or mints, tissues, spare earrings, paper and pen.

☐ **Prepare wedding clothes**

☐ **Prepare wedding rings and papers/documents**

☐ **To sleep well!**

Maybe a small drink or valerian will help here?!

Checklist - your wedding day

☐ **Enjoy your day!**

You have planned everything well, small mistakes are normal and you just have to improvise. But you shouldn't do the improvising; it's the job of the wedding contact person who has everything in his hands during the wedding celebration and makes decisions in your best interest.

☐ **Have fun on your honeymoon!**

Checklist - up to 4 weeks after the wedding

☐ **Pay all bills**

☐ **Writing and sending wedding thank you cards**

☐ **Choose wedding photos from the photographer and/or video sequences from the videographer**

☐ Have your wedding wardrobe cleaned

You can keep the wedding dress and suit as a souvenir (keep them carefully) or sell them. auch verkaufen.

☐ Make name changes

Have you changed your last name? Then you should also think about the following:

- Change doorbell and mailbox sign
- Inform employer -> present marriage certificate
- Inform financial institutions / credit card institutions / insurance companies / building societies
- Adjust phone book entry if still relevant
- Inform the tax office
- Inform your health insurance
- Inform magazine/newspaper publisher
- Inform the gas and electricity company
- Apply for a passport and identity card
- Change your tax card
- Apply for a new driver's license
- Adjust vehicle documents and inform motor vehicle insurance
- Adjust other contracts

The information provided in this document is not guaranteed to be correct or complete. It is essential that you check for up-to-dateness yourself. This checklist or guidance document is intended only as a guide, as the legal situation in particular can change at any time.

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